

Build a To-do List App

Using the Ionic 4 Framework

This tutorial will help you build a to-do list mobile application, using the Ionic 4 Framework, within a few minutes.



Mobile apps have become a crucial part of our lives. For example, if you are hungry, you can use an app to order some food. Bills pending? You can pay them using digital payment apps. Want to buy new clothes? Open an e-commerce mobile app, choose what you like, and purchase it. How very practical!

Today there are a number of mobile platforms for apps. Android and the iOS mobile OS platforms have the highest market share. Apps can be developed for each specific platform or device but doing so can be a tedious task. Let's say you have an idea for an app and want to build it for each of your target platforms—Android and iOS. More efforts and resources will be required, as it will be like developing the same app twice using platform-specific SDKs and APIs. This can be

time consuming and difficult to maintain. What if there was a framework or SDK to build an app that will run on all platforms? This is where Ionic, a hybrid mobile application development framework, comes into the picture.

The Ionic Framework

The Ionic Framework is a complete open source SDK for hybrid mobile app development. The original version was built on top of AngularJS and Apache Cordova. The latest release, Ionic 4, was rebuilt as a set of Web components, which allow the user to select any modern UI framework, such as Angular, Vue or React. You can also use Ionic components without any UI framework. Ionic provides tools and services for developing hybrid mobile apps, desktop apps and progressive Web apps based on modern Web development technologies like HTML, CSS and

JavaScript. We can build mobile apps using these Web technologies, and by leveraging Cordova or Capacitor, we can distribute the apps through native app stores for installation on devices.

Ionic is one of the most popular and easy-to-learn hybrid mobile app development frameworks. With over 40,000 stars and almost 13,000 forks at the time of writing this article, it is also one of the most popular and actively maintained mobile development frameworks on GitHub. Thousands of mobile app developers around the world use Ionic to develop mobile apps.

Features of the Ionic Framework

The Ionic Framework uses Cordova and has recently added Capacitor plugins to gain access to the host operating system's features and to features of mobiles such as the camera, flashlight, GPS, etc. Ionic allows app building and deployment by wrapping around the Cordova or Capacitor plugins with a simplified 'Ionic' command line tool. Users can build their apps using modern Web technologies, and these can be customised for Android, iOS, Desktop (with Electron) and modern browsers.

Besides the SDK, Ionic also provides services that developers can use to enable features, such as code deploys and automated builds. Ionic apps run with partial native code and Web code, providing full access to native functionality if necessary, with the UI of the app built with modern Web technologies.